globally. Thus, terrorism has transcended from the local character and has assumed perilous proportions and transnational character at an alarming pace (See page 510 for ISIS).

## State-Sponsored Terrorism

Another form of terrorism, which has emerged, is the state-supported terrorism. Between 1970s and 1980s it became quite clear that an increasing number of states supported the idea of providing support to the insurgents and terrorists in another state as an instrument of statecraft. Shultz*, an expert on Low-Intensity Conflict, observes that "it is an indirect and potentially low-cost means of attacking an adversary without having to resort to open, interstate armed conflict". The USSR and its East European allies, the Western bloc as well as several Middle Eastern countries such as Iran, Iraq, Syria and Libya have allegedly been aiding and abating terrorism. Cuba, North Korea and Yemen reportedly also support terrorism. In the South Asian context, Pakistan is alleged of extending support and training to the separatist elements in India and the Mumbai terror siege of 26/11/2008 revealed the Pakistani connections. Bangladesh too serves as a safe haven for terrorist elements who also have links with the Pakistani intelligence and international terrorist organizations. They too pose a security threat to the Indian state. Therefore, state-sponsored terrorism is a real challenge to the security and existence of a state with a number of adversaries, each wanting to score a victory over it through subversive means.

## Cyber-Terrorism

Improvement in technologies and telecommunication system is gradually changing the face of terrorism. Attacks by terrorists are not confined to the real world only, for they have made inroads into the virtual world too. Security risks emanating from disruption of working of computer systems, networks, Internet with an objective to cause harm, threaten or shock the target audience/group, individual or a particular government tantamount to cyber-terrorism.

There may be ordinary to professional hackers who might also commit cyber crime, but that may be a bit different from the cyber-